

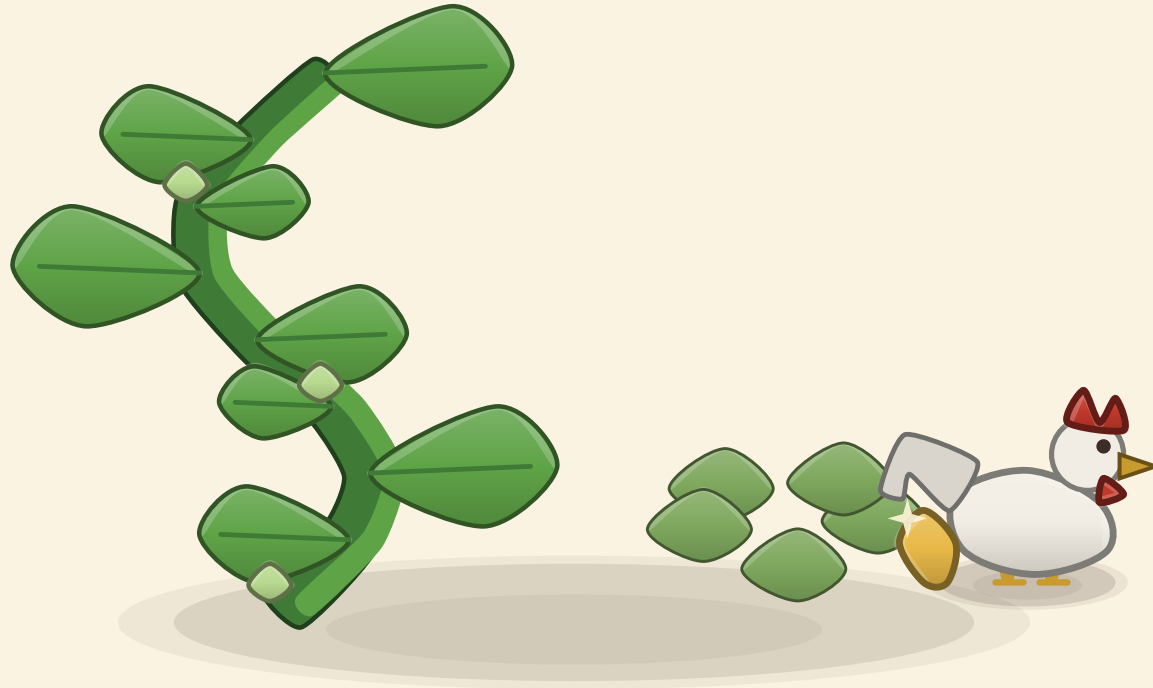
★ Jack and the Beanstalk ★

an old fairy tale, told again



Jack and the Beanstalk

after the English folk tale



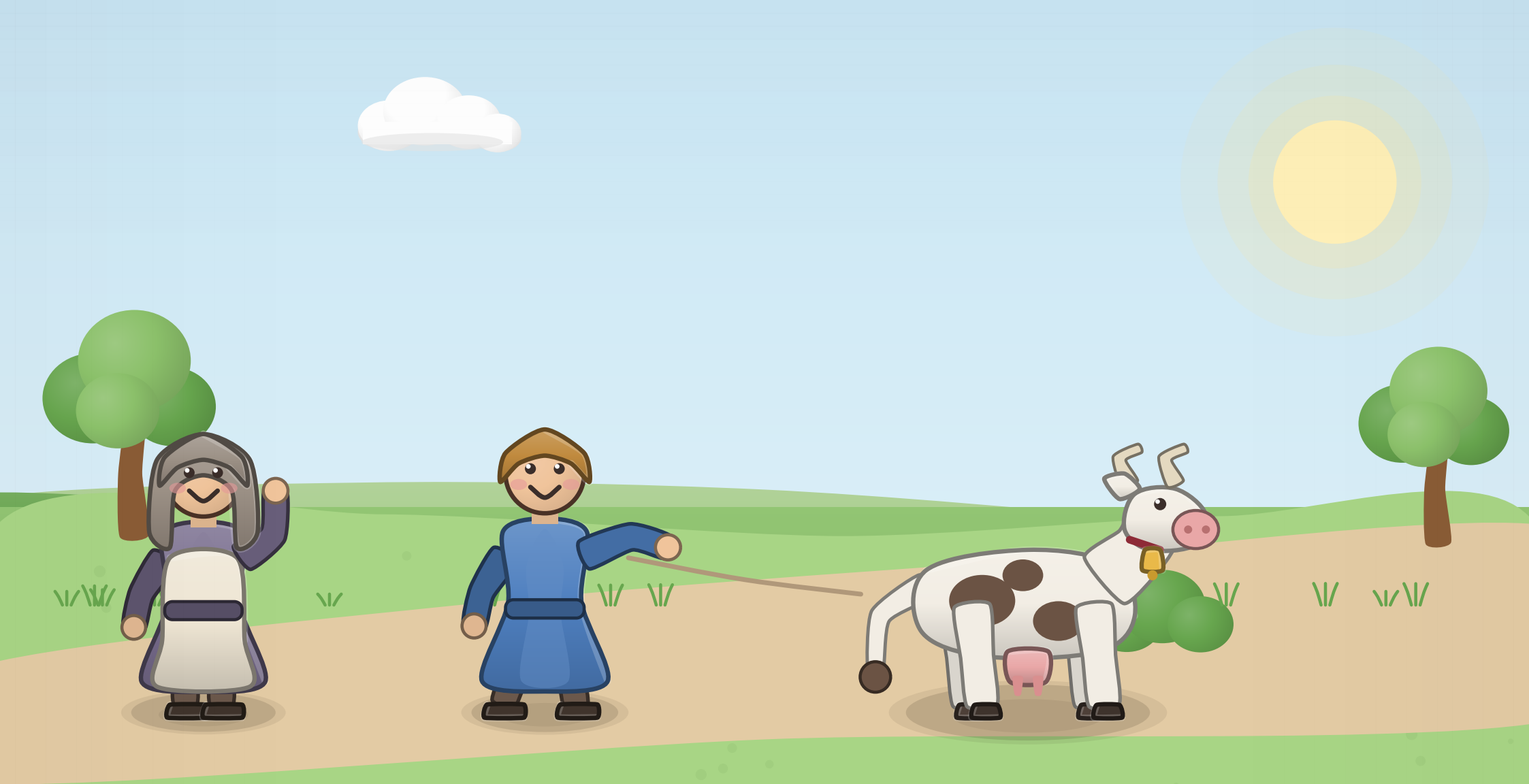
This book belongs to

A retelling of the English folk tale, printed in many versions since 1734.

Illustrations drawn as vector art. Made to be read aloud.



Jack lived with his mother in a small house at the edge of a field. They had no money at all, and nothing left to sell — except Milky-White, the cow.

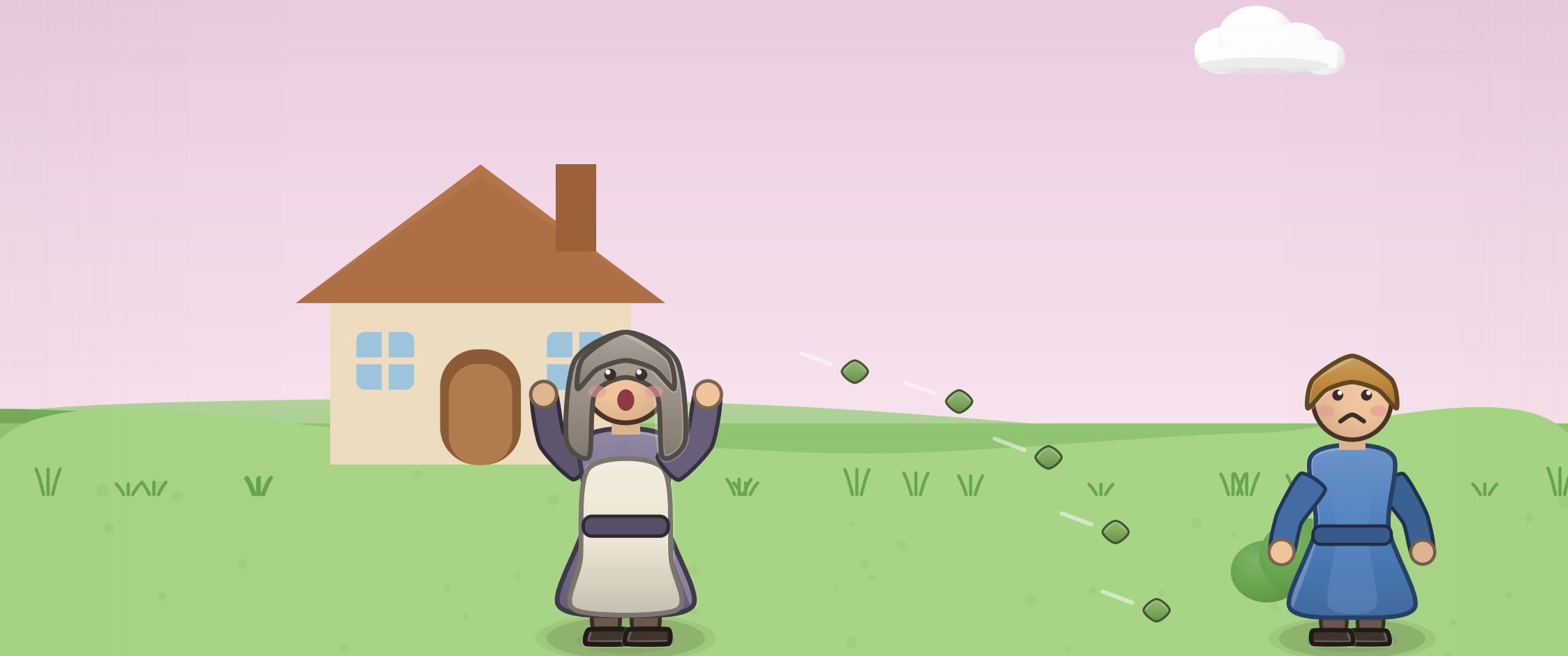


“Take her to market,” said his mother, “and mind you get a good price.”
So Jack took the rope, and off the two of them went down the lane.

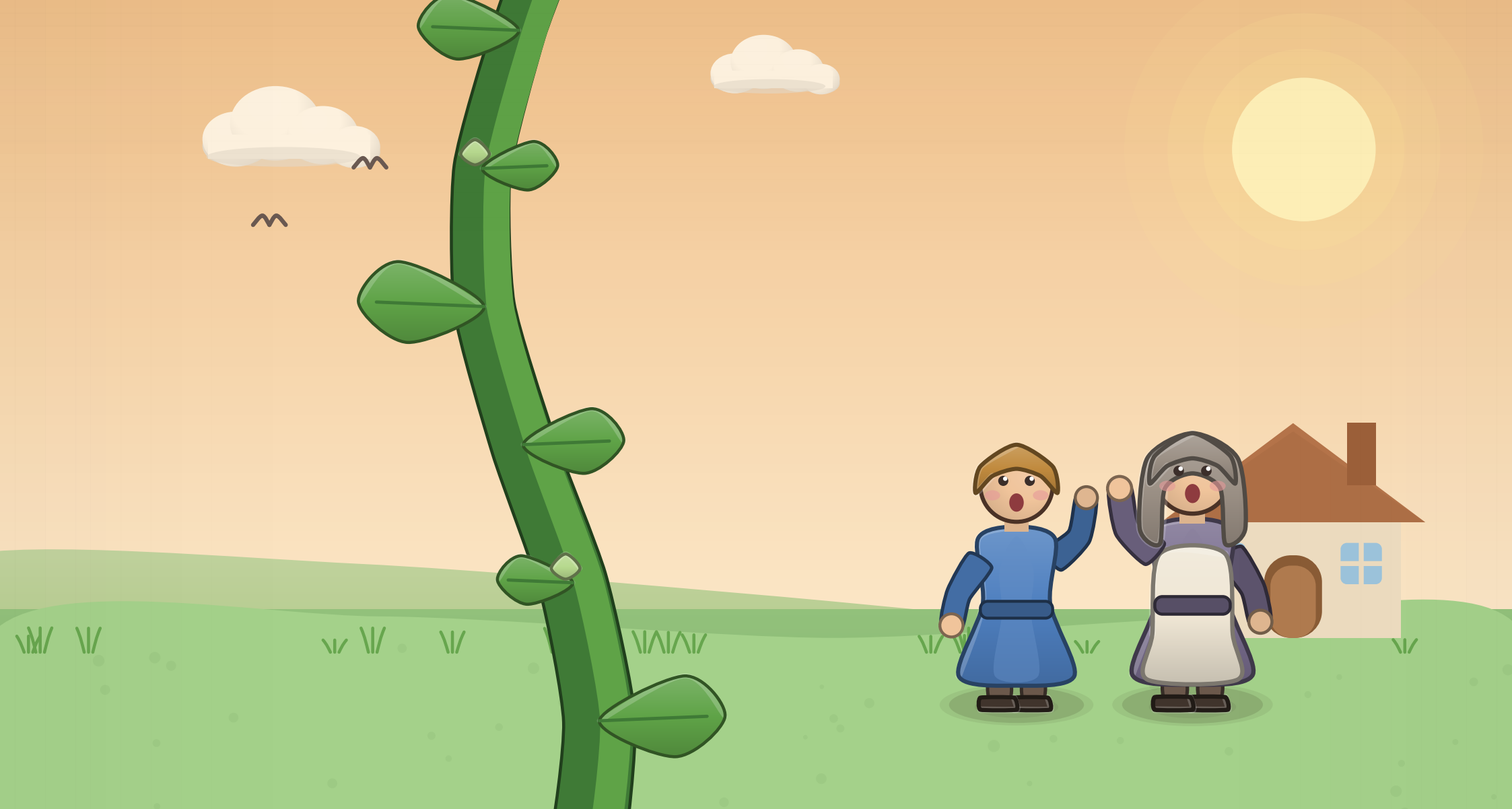


On the road he met an old man with a hat like a chimney pot.
“Five beans for your cow,” said the old man. “They are magic beans. Plant them
tonight and see.”

Jack thought that sounded much more interesting than money.



His mother did not think so.
“Beans!” she cried, and threw them straight out of the window. And there was
no supper for anybody.



But in the morning the garden had gone dark, and green, and very quiet.
A beanstalk had grown in the night — up past the roof, up past the birds, up
past the clouds.



So Jack climbed.

He climbed past the swifts, and past the rain, and past the top of the sky, until the whole world below was a small green handkerchief.



At the top was a road of cloud, and at the end of it a castle with a door as tall as a tree.

A very large woman was sweeping the step. "You poor thin thing," she said, and gave him bread and milk.



Then the floor began to shake.
“Fee, fi, fo, fum!” came a voice like a landslide. “Quick,” whispered the woman,
“into the pot!”
Jack got in and pulled the lid over his head.



The Giant sat down and counted his gold — one hundred, two hundred, three hundred — and his head grew heavy, and his chin came down on his chest, and he began to snore like a storm at sea.



Jack came out on tiptoe, took one bag of gold, and went down the beanstalk faster than he had ever gone down anything.

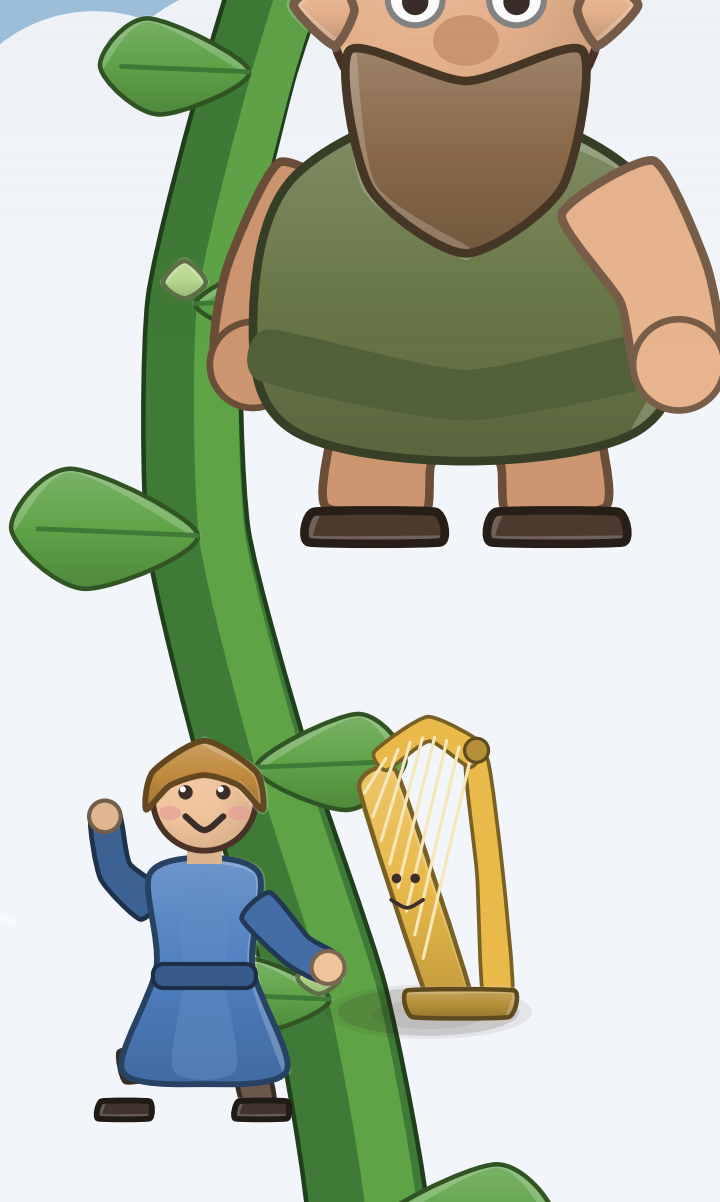
His mother forgave him about the cow.



The gold lasted a good while. When it ran out, Jack climbed again — and this time he came home with a little brown hen who laid, whenever you asked her nicely, an egg of solid gold.

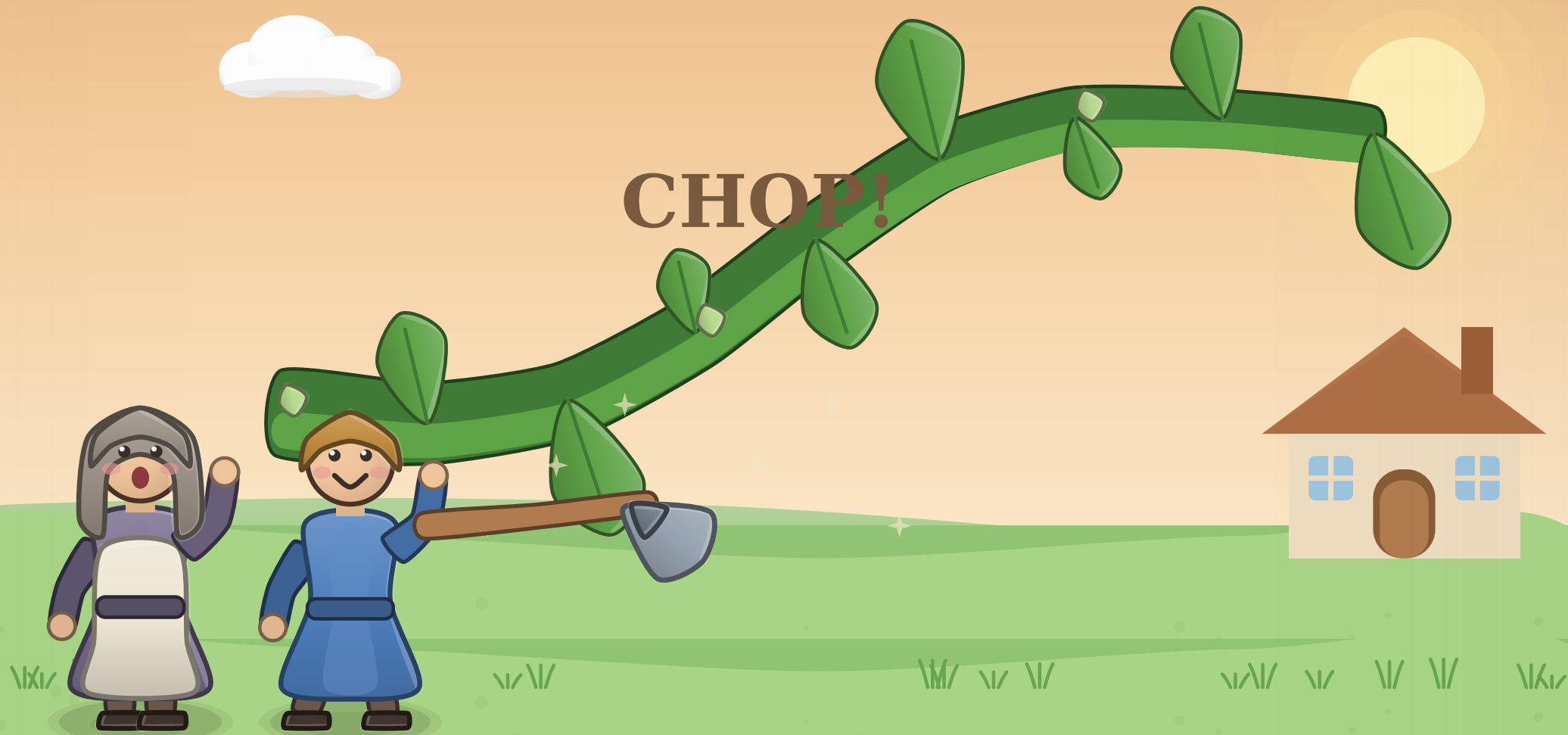


The third time, he took the golden harp.
But the harp was an enchanted harp, and it opened one eye and sang out:
“Master! Master! Somebody is stealing me!”



Down the beanstalk went Jack with the harp under his arm, and after him came the Giant, shaking every leaf.

“Mother!” shouted Jack. “The axe! Bring the axe!”



Chop went the axe, and chop, and CHOP — and the great beanstalk came down
across the field like a falling mast.

The Giant never came down it again, and Jack and his mother were never
hungry after that.



The End

★ “Fee, fi, fo, fum — I smell the breakfast of an Englishman!” ★

